Consultation response checklist

Prepared by Yann Stoneman, a Kew Riverside Primary School parent seeking to keep the school open. Budget and forecast update checked 8 October 2026; deadline rechecked 8 October; closing-school guidance checked 26 September 2026. This is not an official consultation form or legal advice.

Before submitting

- ☐ Respond by 16 October 2026, the date on the council-linked form when checked on 8 October. No closing time is stated; check for updates.
- ☐ This is pre-statutory consultation. A later statutory notice would have a separate representation period.
- ☐ Read the council's proposal and supporting evidence. Choose the questions that matter to you; personal experience matters too.
- ☐ State the outcome you seek: retention of the current school, teaching on the site, or another specific arrangement.
- ☐ Respond on time even if requested records are outstanding. Keep a copy and seek an acknowledgement.

Build a concise case

- ☐ **1. The budget bridge**
  The received final budget summary forecasts a £212,417 annual gap in 2026/27, about £19,268 left at March 2027, and a £457,702 accumulated deficit by 2028/29. Ask for the ledger, current monitoring and assumptions; other reserve-exhaustion wording conflicts.
- ☐ **2. A deliverable alternative**
  Which costed arrangements could retain education at Kew? Ask about the delivery body, premises, three-year budget and reasons for rejecting each option. A possible legal route alone is not a viable plan.
- ☐ **3. Net closure costs**
  Ask which PFI and other costs stop, continue or arise because of closure, including transition, receiving-school support and travel. Compare annual net costs, not the school deficit alone.
- ☐ **4. Local pupil demand**
  Ask which cohort and housing assumptions changed between forecast versions, and what is forecast after 2031/32. A key test in government guidance is whether the need for places is forecast to rise over the medium to long term (Closing maintained schools, May 2026, page 8). Compare forecasts with actuals for the same year and area; the earlier 2025/26 Kew-area total was close to actual, while the separate borough check found overprediction.
- ☐ **5. Continuity and equality**
  Ask for staffed places by year group, the Kew-specific equality assessment, SEND support, safe journeys, effects on disadvantaged pupils and funded transition arrangements. Decision-makers should consider travel, extra car use and the quality of alternative places, balanced against the need to reduce surplus places (same guidance, pages 21-22). Use anonymised public examples; share a child's individual needs privately through official services.
- ☐ **6. Learning**
  Ask what each option would preserve or change about teaching, relationships, curriculum and support. Current results and inspection describe existing provision, not the effects of a future option.

Write and submit your response

Suggested response structure

- ☐ My connection to the school or area.
- ☐ My requested outcome.
- ☐ My strongest evidence, with document titles, dates and page references.
- ☐ A viable alternative or a precise request for further appraisal.
- ☐ Specific pupil or community impacts, with evidence. A statutory proposal must address community impact (same guidance, page 28).
- ☐ Questions that remain unanswered.
- ☐ A request for acknowledgement and a response to the substantive points.

Official starting points

Check the official response form for the latest deadline and any updates before submitting.

Richmond Council

https://www.richmond.gov.uk/services/children_and_family_care/schools_and_colleges/school_organisation_consultations/kew_riverside_consultation

Official response form

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSda5oPsdUlrJkf6vACC_AjvXFR6-ki3iBymNIF5BAWNxf85xQ/viewform

Other participation routes

Check meeting arrangements before registering a speaker or submitting a written question:

https://www.richmond.gov.uk/council/have_your_say/participating_in_council_meetings

Check petition eligibility and handling rules:

https://www.richmond.gov.uk/council/have_your_say/petitions

A petition does not replace a formal consultation response or establish a veto.

Keep your source details

Record each source's publisher, exact title, date, public URL and relevant page or paragraph. Label forecasts, claims by a publisher and your own analysis separately. Avoid sharing identifiable information about children.

This is a research snapshot, with budget and forecast updates on 8 October 2026. Check current official material before acting.